

DIRECT AND INDIRECT NARRATION

Direct Narration

Quoting someone's exact words
e.g., "She said, 'I am going to the store.'"

Indirect Narration

Reporting someone's words without quoting exactly
e.g., "She said that she was going to the store."

Rules for Changing:

1. Change verb tense (backshift):

Present Simple —————> Past Simple

Present Continuous —————> Past Continuous

Present Perfect —————> Past Perfect

2. Change pronouns:

First person (I, me, my) —————> Third person (he, she, him, her)

Second person (you) —————> Third person (he, she, him, her)

3. Remove quotation marks.

4. Use reporting verbs (said, told, asked).

Examples:

1. Direct: "I love reading books," she said.

Indirect: She said that she loved reading books.

2. Direct: "What are you doing?" he asked.

Indirect: He asked what I was doing.

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1 Change to Indirect Narration

1. "I am going to the movies," she said.
2. "What time is it?" he asked.
3. "I have finished my homework," the student said.
4. "Don't touch the glass," the teacher warned.
5. "I will meet you at 5 pm," she promised.
6. "Where are you going?" the stranger asked.
7. "I love playing soccer," the boy said.
8. "Be careful," the mother cautioned.
9. "I have never been to Paris," he said.
10. "What do you want to eat?" the father asked.

Exercise 2 Change to Direct Narration

1. She said that she was tired.
2. He asked what I was doing.
3. The teacher told us to be quiet.
4. She said that she loved reading novels.
5. He asked where I lived.
6. The doctor advised me to take rest.

7. She said that she would meet me soon.
8. The teacher asked if I had finished my work.
9. He said that he had never seen that movie.
10. She told me to be careful.

Exercise 3 Identify Direct or Indirect Narration

1. "I am going to the gym," he said.
2. She said that she would call me later.
3. "What are you doing tonight?" he asked.
4. The teacher told us to submit our assignments.
5. "I love playing music," she said.
6. He said that he had finished his project.
7. "Don't forget to call me," she reminded.
8. The doctor advised me to take medication.
9. "I will meet you at 7 pm," he promised.
10. She said that she had visited many countries.